

And if you really are looking for an application that emulates a joystick or gamepad using key presses and mouse movements, you should give VJoy Virtual Joystick Driver a go.

Printer emulator

If you don't have a printer attached — who uses a printer these days anyway — the print function can still be of some use.

Printing a document is useful if you want to create an uneditable version that preserves the formatting of the document. For this can easily find virtual printers that output PDF files instead of actually printing anything.

There are dozens of such software, some prominent examples being CutePDF, novaPDF, and doPDF. In fact this feature is built into Google



You can use multiple mice together to emulate a multi-touch display using Multi-Touch Vista.

Chrome. Windows too has an inbuilt virtual printer but it only supports printing to .xps files (their alternative to pdf).

Another virtual printer that you will find in Windows is the Fax feature, which is installed as a printer driver. Not much use these days, since fax machines are basically obsolete and you're unlikely to have a modem installed in your computer anyway.

Et al

There are many many other use cases for emulation. A lot of them have to do with emulating hardware that is hard to come by or hard to automate in testing, or to test software that interacts with such hardware.